

AYDEN YOUNG

SUMMARY

PhD Candidate in Economics at the University of California, Santa Cruz. Research applies causal inference to housing markets, consumer credit, and public infrastructure to support policy-relevant decisions. Experienced building and analyzing large-scale administrative datasets in secure data environments, communicating findings to technical and non-technical audiences, and designing research to answer applied questions with real-world stakes. Proficient in R and Python; working experience with SQL and Haver.

SKILLS

- **Causal Inference & Methods:** Difference-in-Differences, Matching (propensity score, feature distance), Regression Discontinuity, Instrumental Variables, Synthetic Control, A/B Testing, Double Machine Learning, Forest Methods
 - **Programming & Data Tools:** R (proficient), Python (proficient), SQL, Haver Analytics, Tableau
 - **Spatial Analysis:** sf, tigris, tidycensus (R)
 - **Data Environments:** Secure data hub administration (California Policy Lab), large-scale administrative panel data, consumer credit records, FHWA infrastructure data
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EMPLOYMENT

- San José State University • Lecturer • Aug 2026 – Present
 - Sole instructor of record for Intermediate Macroeconomics (Econ 102); responsible for course design, lectures, and assessment for a class of undergraduate students.
 - University of California at Santa Cruz • Graduate Student Instructor • Aug 2025 – Aug 2026
 - Instructor of record for Intermediate Macroeconomics (Econ 100b).
 - University of California at Santa Cruz • Teaching Assistant • Aug 2022 – Aug 2025
 - Supported instruction across eight courses including Econometrics, Public Finance, and Python for Data Science.
 - Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation • Student Trainee Economist • Jan 2022 – Aug 2022
 - Produced economic reports and data dashboards for internal policy audiences, maintaining 508-compliance standards requiring clear, accessible communication for non-technical readers.
 - Updated and maintained economic datasets using Haver Analytics; developed Excel-based reporting tools for regional economists.
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POLICY RESEARCH

3. Housing Discrimination, Credit, and Economic Opportunity (with P. Christensen & J. West)
Draft in preparation; data access through California Policy Lab Secure Data Hub
 - Uses experimental audit data on housing discrimination linked to panel consumer credit records to measure how financial attributes such as credit score shape access to rental housing for demographically distinct applicants. Conducted in R and SQL through the California Policy Lab's Secure Data Hub at UC Santa Cruz.
 - Findings bear directly on fair lending policy, housing affordability interventions, and the downstream credit consequences of discrimination.
2. Bridge Sufficiency and Shared Maintenance Responsibilities (with J. Marion)
Draft in preparation
 - Examines how shared public maintenance responsibilities between state and local highway authorities affect infrastructure outcomes across the US bridge network, using FHWA administrative data on over 600,000 bridge inspections.
 - Applies Mahalanobis matching and panel econometric methods to isolate the causal effect of jurisdictional structure on bridge condition ratings; informs debate on intergovernmental coordination and infrastructure investment.
1. Guest Speaker, HUD Office of Economic Affairs Research Roundtable • July 2022
 - Presented research on housing market dynamics to policy economists at the Department of Housing and Urban Development.

EDUCATION

- University of California at Santa Cruz • PhD in Economics • Aug 2022 – Exp. June 2027
- University of California at Santa Cruz • MA in Economics • 2023
- University of Illinois at Chicago • BS in Economics and Applied Statistics (Summa Cum Laude) • 2022

GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

- Dissertation Year Fellowship, UCSC • \$19,000 • 2026–2027
 - Institute for Social Transformation Catalyze Award (with J. West) • \$9,500 • 2025
 - Dissertation Research Grant, UCSC • \$9,500 • 2025
 - Regents Fellowship, UCSC • \$16,000 • 2022–2023
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REFERENCES

- Jeremy West • Associate Professor, UCSC
Research coauthor on housing discrimination project; can speak to applied research design, policy relevance of findings, and data infrastructure work.
- Justin Marion • Professor, UCSC
Academic advisor and coauthor; can speak to research methodology, independent research capacity, and project management.
- J. Will Greene • Regional Economist, FDIC
Supervised applied economics work at the FDIC; can speak to policy communication, data reporting, and professional conduct in a government research environment.